

Day 41: Grade 6 practice paper 1: sections 1-3

Papers · about 40 minutes: warm-up 5 · teach 10 · together 10 · on his own 12 · game 3

1 · WARM-UP (5 MIN)

Today's practice in Philip's corner, or the first two 'together' questions below.

2 · TEACH (10 MIN)

Say: "Exam conditions today: quiet, no help, watch the time."

- Our own Grade 6 practice paper (in the lesson pack). Today: sections 1 to 3, the writing questions, timed at about 1 hour 30 minutes.
- Exam conditions: quiet room, no help.

Worked example

Before you start.

1. Pencils, rubber, ruler.
2. Read every question first.
3. Plan the timing: 25, 25, 35 minutes.

Watch out for

- Writing in pen.
- Skipping the plan for the composition.

In the exam: The real paper has all five questions in one 3-hour sitting.

Show him these cards

1

Practice paper 1, questions 1 to 3: the writing half.

2

Work steadily: plan, write, check.

3

Photograph your composition for feedback.

3 · DO TOGETHER (10 MIN)

- Do sections 1-3 of practice paper 1.

4 · ON HIS OWN (12 MIN)

- Photograph the composition and get feedback in the Compose game.

5 · GAME (3 MIN)

A treat afterwards.

MOVE ON WHEN

Mark it next time.

Day 42: Practice paper 1: sections 4-5

Papers · about 40 minutes: warm-up 5 · teach 10 · together 10 · on his own 12 · game 3

1 · WARM-UP (5 MIN)

Today's practice in Philip's corner, or the first two 'together' questions below.

2 · TEACH (10 MIN)

- Sections 4 and 5 of practice paper 1: the score questions, about 1 hour 15 minutes.

3 · DO TOGETHER (10 MIN)

- Do sections 4-5 of practice paper 1, or on screen.

4 · ON HIS OWN (12 MIN)

- Mark the paper with the marking key, then record the marks.

5 · GAME (3 MIN)

His choice.

MOVE ON WHEN

Marks recorded. 75 or more out of 100: on track. Below 66: spend extra days on the weakest section.

Day 43: Mark paper 1 and fix the weakest section

Papers · about 40 minutes: warm-up 5 · teach 10 · together 10 · on his own 12 · game 3

1 · WARM-UP (5 MIN)

Today's practice in Philip's corner, or the first two 'together' questions below.

2 · TEACH (10 MIN)

- Go through every lost mark and find the day that teaches it.
- Redo every wrong answer.

3 · DO TOGETHER (10 MIN)

- Redo the wrong answers together.

4 · ON HIS OWN (12 MIN)

- Five fresh questions on each weak topic.

5 · GAME (3 MIN)

His choice.

MOVE ON WHEN

The weakest section is fixed.

Day 44: Grade 6 practice paper 2 (full, 3 hours)

Papers · about 40 minutes: warm-up 5 · teach 10 · together 10 · on his own 12 · game 3

1 · WARM-UP (5 MIN)

Today's practice in Philip's corner, or the first two 'together' questions below.

2 · TEACH (10 MIN)

Say: “This is the full rehearsal. Take a break if you need one, but keep to exam rules.”

- Practice paper 2 in one sitting, timed at 3 hours. Treat it as the real exam.

Worked example

Checking routine.

1. Q1-2: consecutives, leading note, 7ths, complete chords.
2. Q3: bars add up, cadences, directions.
3. Q4-5: every part answered.

Watch out for

- Starting when tired.
- Leaving answers blank.

In the exam: 75 or more on paper 2: ready to book.

Show him these cards

1

Practice paper 2: the full 3 hours, like the real exam.

2

Use your timing plan, and keep 25 minutes to check.

3

You've done this before: stay calm.

3 · DO TOGETHER (10 MIN)

- Our Grade 6 practice paper 2 (in today's lesson pack).

4 · ON HIS OWN (12 MIN)

- A treat afterwards.

5 · GAME (3 MIN)

Mark it next time.

MOVE ON WHEN

undefined

Day 45: Mark paper 2 and fix

Papers · about 40 minutes: warm-up 5 · teach 10 · together 10 · on his own 12 · game 3

1 · WARM-UP (5 MIN)

Today's practice in Philip's corner, or the first two 'together' questions below.

2 · TEACH (10 MIN)

- Mark together and log every mistake by section.
- Compare with paper 1: which sections improved?

3 · DO TOGETHER (10 MIN)

- Redo every wrong answer.

4 · ON HIS OWN (12 MIN)

- Five fresh questions on each topic that lost marks.

5 · GAME (3 MIN)

His choice.

MOVE ON WHEN

75 or more on paper 2: ready to book. 66–74 is a pass but give it another week of fixing. Below 66: don't book yet.

Day 46: Grade 6 practice paper 3 (full, 3 hours)

Papers · about 40 minutes: warm-up 5 · teach 10 · together 10 · on his own 12 · game 3

1 · WARM-UP (5 MIN)

Today's practice in Philip's corner, or the first two 'together' questions below.

2 · TEACH (10 MIN)

Say: “Last full paper. Let's see how far you've come.”

- Practice paper 3, timed at 3 hours, in exam conditions.

Worked example

Compare the papers.

1. Write each question's marks for papers 1, 2 and 3.
2. Circle the biggest improvement.
3. Choose one question to polish.

Watch out for

- Changing everything at the last minute.
- Forgetting to celebrate progress.

In the exam: 75 or more: ready.

Show him these cards

1

Practice paper 3: the last full rehearsal.

2

Compare with papers 1 and 2: which question improved most?

3

Then pick the one weakest question to polish.

3 · DO TOGETHER (10 MIN)

- Our Grade 6 practice paper 3 (in today's lesson pack).

4 · ON HIS OWN (12 MIN)

- A treat afterwards.

5 · GAME (3 MIN)

Mark it next time.

MOVE ON WHEN

undefined

Day 47: Mark paper 3 and polish

Papers · about 40 minutes: warm-up 5 · teach 10 · together 10 · on his own 12 · game 3

1 · WARM-UP (5 MIN)

Today's practice in Philip's corner, or the first two 'together' questions below.

2 · TEACH (10 MIN)

- Mark paper 3. Then polish the writing questions: one more figured bass and one more melody, checked carefully.

3 · DO TOGETHER (10 MIN)

- Redo every wrong answer.

4 · ON HIS OWN (12 MIN)

- Figured bass and Compose games.

5 · GAME (3 MIN)

His choice.

MOVE ON WHEN

Paper 3 at 75 or more: ready.

Day 48: Exam technique and final review

Papers · about 40 minutes: warm-up 5 · teach 10 · together 10 · on his own 12 · game 3

1 · WARM-UP (5 MIN)

Today's practice in Philip's corner, or the first two 'together' questions below.

2 · TEACH (10 MIN)

Say: “You've worked through every part of Grade 6. Trust your method and check your work.”

- The exam: 3 hours, on paper, at an exam centre. Bring pencils, a rubber and a ruler.
- Suggested timing: question 1, figured bass (15 marks) 25 min, question 2, chords for a melody (15) 25 min, question 3 (20) 35 min, questions 4 and 5 (25 each) 35 min each, then 25 min to check.
- Check every harmony answer for consecutives, the leading note and 7ths; check the composition has performance directions.
- Extra practice papers 4, 5 and 6 are in the Papers list for after the course or for the weeks before the exam: they include melodies that modulate and keyboard-style figured bass.
- The Grade 6 question bank (in the Papers list) has about 100 more questions by topic, with model answers for the writing questions.

Worked example

Exam-day checklist.

1. Entry details and ID if needed.
2. Pencils, rubber, ruler, water.
3. Arrive early.

Watch out for

- Cramming the night before.
- Rushing the last question without checking.

In the exam: Read the candidate instructions from ABRSM before the day.

Show him these cards

1

The exam is 3 hours on paper at an exam centre. Bring pencils, a rubber and a ruler.

2

Timing: Q1 (figured bass) and Q2 (chords for a melody) 25 minutes each, Q3 35, Q4 and Q5 35 each, then 25 minutes to check.

3

The day before: rest, play your violin, sleep well.

3 · DO TOGETHER (10 MIN)

- A light mixed review: 10 questions.

Four questions to work through together

1. What does this mean?

con spirito

- A. with vigour, lively B. one player alone C. with spirit D. lightly

Answer: with spirit. con spirito is Italian for "with spirit".

2. What does this mean?

sotto voce

- A. getting faster (pressing on) B. swiftly C. in a hushed voice, very quietly D. gracefully

Answer: in a hushed voice, very quietly. sotto voce is Italian for "in a hushed voice, very quietly".

3. Which term means "furiously"?

- A. legato B. leggiero C. larghetto D. furioso

Answer: furioso. furioso is Italian for "furiously".

4. What does this mean?

ruhig

- A. the end B. peaceful C. singing D. without a mute

Answer: peaceful. ruhig is German for "peaceful".

4 • ON HIS OWN (12 MIN)

- Word cards and Match pairs.

His worksheet is on the next page (answers at the end).

5 • GAME (3 MIN)

Finish on something he's good at.

MOVE ON WHEN

Ready. Rest the day before the exam.

Philip's worksheet · Day 48

Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 8

1. What does this mean?

subito

- A. as if, almost B. furiously C. getting slower D. suddenly

2. What does this mean?

furioso

- A. very B. furiously C. with some freedom of time D. damped, muffled notes

3. What does this mean?

legato

- A. with movement B. noisily, boisterously C. loud, then immediately quiet D. smoothly

4. What does this mean?

sforzato (sfz)

- A. forced, accented B. sadly C. but not too much D. gracefully

5. What does this mean?

quasi

- A. slow down B. as if, almost C. with D. with a mute

6. What does this mean?

ad libitum (ad lib.)

- A. gradually getting louder B. at choice, freely C. noisily, boisterously D. very fast

7. Which French word means "in time"?

- A. en mesure B. con forza C. mezzo forte (mf) D. assai

8. Which term means "very, much"?

- A. attacca B. molto C. largamente D. con

ANSWERS (FOR MUM)

1. **D: suddenly.** subito is Italian for "suddenly".
2. **B: furiously.** furioso is Italian for "furiously".
3. **D: smoothly.** legato is Italian for "smoothly".
4. **A: forced, accented.** sforzato (sfz) is Italian for "forced, accented".
5. **B: as if, almost.** quasi is Italian for "as if, almost".
6. **B: at choice, freely.** ad libitum (ad lib.) is Italian for "at choice, freely".
7. **A: en mesure.** en mesure is French for "in time".
8. **B: molto.** molto is Italian for "very, much".